



Then it was Thor's turn. "No one can drink more than me," he boasted, so the giants gave him a horn brimming with ale.

"Drain this and you win," Utgarda-Loki said.

Thor began to drink, and drink and drink. His face reddened, ale spilled down his beard, his stomach swelled to bursting point, but still the horn stayed full.

"Another giant victory!" Utgarda-Loki said. "How about an easier challenge?"

"Like what?" Thor said sulkily.

Utgarda-Loki pointed to a cat sitting placidly by the fire. "Lift him up."



*"Huh! That's no challenge!" And yet, try as he might, Thor could only lift up one of the cat's paws. "What's wrong with me?" he cried.*

"Well now," Utgarda-Loki said, smirking, "surely you can beat an old woman at wrestling?"

Thor puffed out his chest. "Of course I can. Show me my opponent!"

"Elli," Utgarda-Loki called, and a small, scrawny woman hobbled in. Long and fiercely they fought, with Thor being humiliatingly thrown around the hall like a ragdoll. Utgarda-Loki held up his hand. "No more contests," he said, and they spent the rest of the night feasting and getting along surprisingly well.

